

JESSICA LAZEN

QUANTITATIVE SOCIAL SCIENTIST

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EDUCATION

New York University

M.S. Applied Statistics for Social Science
Research | 2023 - 2025

- Relevant Coursework: Statistical Computing, Survey Methods, Frequentist & Bayesian Inference, Machine Learning, Deep Learning, Multilevel Models, Generalized Linear Models, Latent Variable Models, Psychometric Measurement, Causal Inference, Messy Data, Data Journalism, Data Ethics

Rutgers University

B.S. Cognitive Science | 2017 - 2021

- Honors thesis: Eccentric Beliefs — Bayesianism and The Psychological Immune System

AWARDS

Paul Robeson Scholar | 2021

Aresty Research Fellowship | 2018 - 2019

James Dickson Carr Scholar | 2017 - 2021

SKILLS

Programming & Data Tools

Advanced R (tidyverse, ggplot2) · Python (pandas, Matplotlib, scikit-learn, PyTorch) · SQL · Stan · CSS · HTML · Git/GitHub · BigQuery · dbt · Qualtrics · Quarto · LaTeX · LLM & AI-assisted coding tools (Codex, Cursor) · Tableau

Quantitative Research Methods

Experimental Design · Survey Research (Survey Development, Sampling, Bias Mitigation, Conjoint & MaxDiff Analysis) · UX Research (Usability Testing, Structured Interviews) · Product & Behavioral Analytics (Logs Analysis, A/B Testing) · Data Visualization

Statistical Modeling & ML

Descriptive & Inferential Statistics (Hypothesis Testing, ANOVA) · Causal Inference Methods (RCTs, DiD, IV, RDD, Propensity Scores) · Linear & Generalized Linear Models · Multilevel Models · Tree-Based Models · Clustering (K-Means, Hierarchical, Model-Based) · NLP (Topic Modeling, Sentiment Analysis)

Latent Variable & Multivariate Methods

Factor Analysis · Latent Class Analysis · Item Response Theory · Gaussian Mixture Models · Dimensionality Reduction (PCA, LDA)

EXPERIENCE

Research Operations Lead

New York University | July 2022 - Present

- Designed and deployed a SQL-based participant database and Shiny CRM system used by 100+ staff to streamline recruitment workflows, reduce manual tracking, and enable faster, data-driven decisions across 40,000+ participant records.
- Built and maintained data pipelines integrating participant data across studies, improving data consistency and enabling cross-team access to up-to-date information.
- Established data governance and data-sharing protocols to support secure, compliant data exchange and reliable use of sensitive research data.

Research Associate

New York University | July 2022 - Present

- Identified novel patterns in social cognition through the management and analysis of 8 large-scale studies on language interpretation and belief formation across age groups.
- Designed survey instruments and experimental protocols to measure essentialist belief formation, analyzed data using mixed-effects models to account for repeated measurements.
- Communicated findings in a first-author publication in the *47th Proceedings of the Cognitive Science Society* (2025).

Quantitative Reasoning Specialist

City University of New York | August 2025 - Present

- Strengthened the methodological rigor of graduate capstone projects by advising students on quantitative research design, statistical analysis, and the communication of findings.
- Translated complex analytical concepts into accessible guidance for non-technical audiences.

Research Associate

Yale University | May 2021 – June 2022

- Designed and conducted original research on moral reasoning across humans, animals, and robots, including administering structured interviews with 50+ child participants to collect high-quality developmental data.

TEACHING

Graduate Adjunct

New York University | September 2025 - December 2025

- Instructed graduate social science students in applied statistics using real-world data and R for analysis and modeling.

Adjunct Lecturer

City University of New York | August 2024 - June 2025

- Designed and taught four sections of Statistics for Social Change, making statistical concepts accessible and socially relevant for non-traditional undergraduate and pre-college students.